



So near, yet so far: Mikel Arteta's (below) Arsenal set the club's season record of 28 wins, but it wasn't enough as losses to West Ham, Fulham and Aston Villa ruined their title chances. Pics: GETTY IMAGES

Nevertheless, the German manager will leave Anfield having delivered Liverpool its first league title in 30 years in 2020, a year after leading the team to Champions League glory.

'Good Evenings' for Villa in Europe

Spaniard Unai Emery took over relegation-threatened Aston Villa in 2022 and led it to the UEFA Europa Conference league in his first season. Villa strengthened its squad ahead of the 2023-24 season by bringing in players like Pau Torres, Moussa Diaby and Youri Tielemans.

Villa managed to rejig the 'big six' in the league and cemented itself in fourth position, guaranteeing a spot in next year's revamped Champions League, marking its first appearance in the competition in 41 years.

Villa's standout player of the season was Ollie Watkins who spearheaded the attack with 19 goals and 13 assists, bagging the Playmaker award at the end of the season.

Chelsea, Tottenham and Manchester United struggle

Despite spending a ludicrous amount of money over the

previous three transfer windows, Chelsea performed below average in the first half of the season.

Former Man City man Cole Palmer was Chelsea's lone bright spot as he registered 22 goals and 11 assists, the highest in the league. His performance earned him the Premier League Young Player of the Season award, helping his side stage a late turnaround.

Chelsea finished in sixth place, three points above Newcastle and Manchester United, who are in seventh and eighth respectively.

Tottenham got off to a flying start under newly appointed Ange Postecoglou, going unbeaten in the first 10 games.

The optimistic start was undone after it managed to get only one point from the next five games (four losses and one draw).

Spurs ended the season in fifth place, securing Europa League football for next season.

While Manchester United manager Erik Ten Hag described his side as one of most "entertaining" in the league, the Red Devils' season ended with their worst

Premier League finish (8th).

Ten Hag's men also ended the campaign with a negative goal difference (-1) for the first time in the side's history.

Dyche to the rescue

Everton became the first team in the top flight of English football to receive two separate points deductions in a single campaign for breaching the profit and sustainability rules.

With a drop into the Championship looming, manager Sean Dyche inspired his side to 13 wins, including its first Merseyside derby victory against Liverpool at Goodison Park in more than 13 years. Despite an eight-point deduction, the Toffees ended the season 14 points clear of the relegation zone.

Premier League too strong for Championship teams

Luton Town, Burnley and Sheffield United were relegated to the Championship, making it only the second time in Premier League history that all three promoted clubs were relegated, after Bolton Wanderers, Barnsley and Crystal Palace did the same in 1997-98.

